QUICK GUIDE

BEAT WAVEFORM

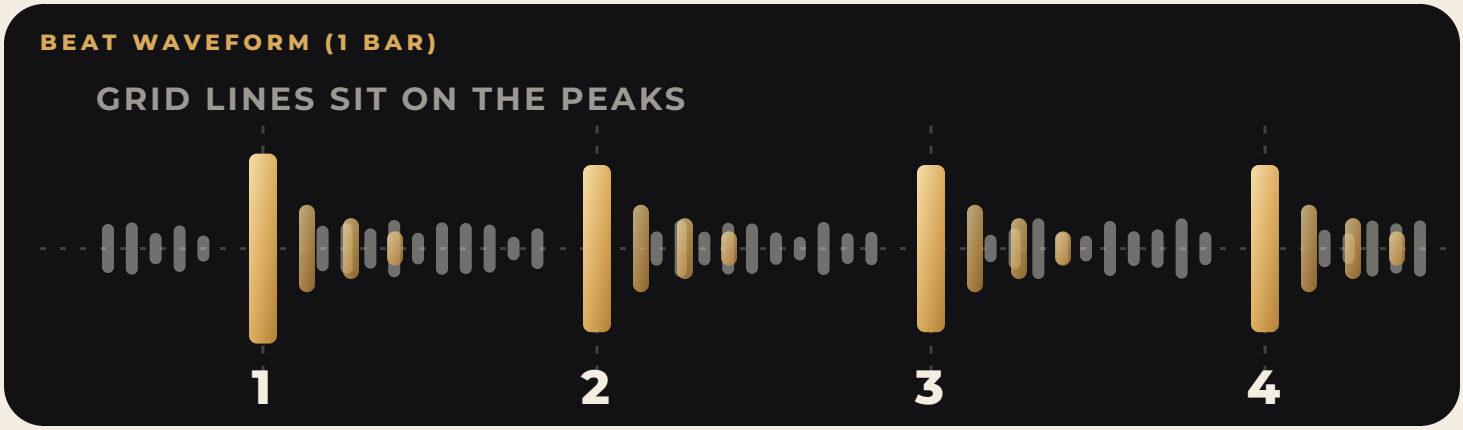
What it is, how to spot it and what to do with it.

WHAT IT IS

A beat waveform shows where the drum hits land. In most dance music, tall peaks repeat at an even spacing. Each peak is a beat, and four beats make a bar.

HOW IT SOUNDS

Steady and predictable. That's exactly what makes it mixable.



01

SPIKES IN A ROW

Evenly spaced peaks mark the beats.

02

COUNT IN FOURS

Four beats make a bar. Most dance tracks phrase in 8, 16 or 32 bars.

03

THIN MEANS BREAKDOWN

Tall, dense means the drop is on.

DO THIS TONIGHT

Zoom in. Put the grid on the peaks. Then mix.

- [ ] Zoom in until you can see each beat.
- [ ] Make sure the grid lines sit on the peaks.
- [ ] Line the next track's peaks up with the same grid.



PRACTICE & CHECK

BEAT WAVEFORM: YOUR TURN

WHERE YOU'LL MEET IT AS A DJ

- Setting and checking your beat grid.
- Spotting breakdowns, builds and drops before they arrive.
- Lining up two tracks by eye as well as by ear.

QUICK CHECK

1. How many beats are in a bar?

2. What does a thin, quiet section usually mean?

3. Where should the grid lines sit?

Answer key: 1) Four, in most dance music. 2) A breakdown. 3) On the beat peaks.

REMEMBER

See the beat. Check the grid. Then mix.

YOUR NOTES

UP NEXT Kick Drum Waveform

